

Rye Country Day School
Model United Nations Conference I

April 18th, 2026



House Un-American Activities Committee
The Cold War & McCarthyism

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Letter from the Secretariat

Dear Delegates and Faculty Advisors,

We are honored and excited to invite you to the inaugural Rye Country Day School Model United Nations Conference (RCDSMUNC I), which will take place on Saturday, April 18th, 2026. RCDS is thrilled to have such an incredible group of students on campus, working together to find solutions to real world issues.

The Secretariat, along with our faculty advisor, Mr. Murray, have been working diligently over the past year to coordinate our first conference. Our goal for RCDSMUNC I is to inspire delegates to collaborate while developing their knowledge on impactful global problems.

Our three committees cover a variety of topics, including the ethics of AI in business, the Equal Pay Act, and the Cold War.

We encourage you all to reach out to your chairs with any questions or concerns, and we hope you have an amazing and engaging conference. Good luck!

Best,

Zara Khemlani, Kevin Neilinger, and Lillian Pereira

RCDSMUNC I Secretariat

Committee Description

The House Un-American Activities Committee (HUAC) was established by Congress in 1938 to respond to growing fear of communist influence in the United States. Although it originated with a focus on communism and facism, as World War II ended and the Cold War began, the Red Scare – an American fear of communist takeover – swept the country. This caused HUAC’s investigations to shift to combating an alleged communist conspiracy to overthrow The United States’ principles of freedom.

Because the very nature of conspiracy is secretive, the committee focused on uncovering information by means of subpoenas, legal orders that summon individuals to court to testify. Their hearings were public, dramatic, and often based on speculation. They drew a lot of public attention, especially since they accused many important figures – including Hollywood celebrities, activists, and high-ranking government officials – of conspiracy. Not only the famous and powerful were targeted; those who held

leftist beliefs, were homosexual, or in any way deviated from the “norm” were at risk of being targeted and blacklisted. The very act of being accused of communism, regardless of the result of trial, was negative publicity and held the power to alter the course of one’s entire career. In addition to subpoenas, the committee often held people in contempt of Congress, the misdemeanor charge entailing refusal to cooperate with the investigation, either by lying or failing to provide requested documents. This made it difficult for anyone to avoid the impacts of the HUAC or walk away from an accusation unaffected. With the amplification of the media, through newspapers, radio, and television, there was little limit to the influence that the HUAC held over a panicked society, regardless of whether their content was true or misinformation.

While Senator Joseph McCarthy was not a member of the committee, HUAC was strongly associated with McCarthyism, or the political movement of “witch-hunting” suspected communists. Composed of members of Congress, this committee held

Congressional powers, but no more than that. Beyond subpoenas and (public) hearings, only referrals would help bring their accusations to judicial attention, which they often received. Again, a referral by the HUAC could blacklist anyone, regardless of the truth, and strip people of livelihood.

While reading about the selected representatives of this committee, please note that some of these representatives were not actually a part of HUAC; rather, their historical significance around the time period of the Red Scare explains their inclusion.

Keep in mind that the members of HUAC believed that they were serving the nation's wellness by prioritizing national security and protecting against what they considered freedom's antithesis, communism. Many members held ulterior motives, involving backroom deals and personal gain – their motivations came from

an “every-man-for-himself” mindset. However, they publicly portrayed their actions in the name of freedom. Anyone who denounced the committee was considered to disregard freedom, thus putting themselves at risk of being blacklisted.

This committee commences in January of 1953, immediately following President Dwight D. Eisenhower's inauguration. At this time, McCarthy holds massive influence and is yet to be seriously challenged, Republicans control Congress, the public widely fears communism, the Korean War is ongoing, and most importantly, there is high tension between the United States and the Soviet Union. This time period is characterized by widespread fear, paranoia, and hysteria.

Background Information

The HUAC came to be as a result of many precursors. The Overman Committee was established in 1918 as an

offshoot of the Senate Judiciary Committee, dedicated to investigating German influence in the United States

during World War I, in which intense nationalism took over the United States. After Germany's defeat in World War I, the committee's attention turned to the Bolsheviks, who, as of 1917, ruled a communist Russia. The Overman Committee's legacy of combating Bolshevism became known as the "First Red Scare", setting the precursor to HUAC's mission.

The Fish Committee was established in 1930 by the House of Representatives to investigate communist stirrings in the United States. Formally called the Special Committee to Investigate Communist Activities in the United States, the Fish Committee conducted thorough investigations and the targeting of civil rights groups and labor unions. This era was largely characterized by progressivism, especially in labor; skilled and unskilled workers formed unions to defend and advocate for their rights from large industrialists and self-centered corporations. Often, these unions held some sort of socialist sentiment, or at least one characterized by welfare, which

drew the attention of the Fish Committee. The committee focused on passing anti-immigration legislation to prevent communist immigrants from entering the nation.

From 1934-1937, the McCormack-Dickstein Committee focused on combating Nazi (fascist) propaganda. It explicitly targeted fascist leaders in the United States, and intensely investigated an alleged scheme to take over the White House, known as the "Business Plot". The "Business Plot" created unrest in the media and hurt President Roosevelt's publicity when he tried to suppress testimony. Foreign powers used the desires of its committee members to gain information, such as the Soviet Union's notable bribing Vice-Chairman Dickstein. This is just one example of how individuals had personal motives to their actions completely behind the scenes and unbeknownst to other committee members.

Established in 1938, the Dies Committee served as the official precursor to HUAC. Led by Texan

Democratic Representative Martin Dies, this committee's original focus was on opposing American disloyalty, particularly dealing with individuals that supported Nazi doctrine (more so focused on combatting government ideology – specifically, facism – than racial convictions. However, as WWII progressed, its focus shifted towards combating internal Japanese threats and communist influence. The Dies Committee notably pushed for Japanese internment in 1941 following the allegation that Japanese fishermen along the California coast were conspiring with the Japanese Navy. Following president Franklin D. Roosevelt's authorization of Japanese internment, in the "Yellow Report", they continued to argue for relocation of Japanese Americans inland, even going as far as to criticize the War Relocation Authority (WRA) for being too lenient with inmates.

On January 3, 1945, the House Committee on Un-American Activities (HUAC) became a permanent, standing committee following John Rankin's resolution. Their official goal was to

investigate alleged threats to free government outlined by the Constitution. These threats included but were not limited to espionage, plotting against the government, and propaganda, the last of which was loosely interpreted and posed a threat to First Amendment rights.

Following President Franklin D. Roosevelt's "New Deal", in which the President hoped to help bring the American economy out of the Great Depression in the 1930s by creating jobs, welfare programs, and protecting unskilled labor unions, labor unions in the United States grew drastically. With partly socialist sentiments, like demanding reforms and higher wages for the low-level workers, their ties to communism grew. Although only a few party-leaders were tied to communism, HUAC focused on investigating unions and framing them as communist. The most notable target (during Dies's reign of the committee) was that of Harry Bridges, a major union activist and president of the International Longshore and Warehouse Union (ILWU). He openly supported various communist

ideals, though completely within his First Amendment rights. HUAC subpoenaed and attempted to deport him to Australia.

The Cold War originated immediately following World War II due to the dissolution of the American and Soviet alliance. Importantly, ideological differences between American capitalist democracy and Soviet communism threatened continued progress. As the Soviet Union liberated European nations from Nazi control, they infiltrated their governments with communism and divided Europe. America, under the leadership of Democratic President Harry Truman, was on high alert of the Soviet Union's expansionist plans. In 1947, Harry Truman announced the "Truman Doctrine", which stated that the United States was committed to protecting and aiding democratic European nations from communist influence. Additionally, Churchill's "Iron Curtain" speech, in which he announced the division in Europe, and the Marshall Plan, in which America sought to help rebuild Western Europe, made the Soviet

Union feel threatened and served as the causes of the Cold War.

The course of war did not see armed conflict, but rather espionage, proxy wars (such as the Korean War), and a nuclear arms race. Both nations advanced their nuclear programs and actively tested weapons, and the fear of nuclear armageddon swept the nation. As this conflict raged on, Americans felt a duty to oppose communism in any way possible, which made HUAC's influence much stronger.

In 1946, the committee almost investigated one of the most blatantly violent organizations, the Ku Klux Klan (KKK). Originally formed during the Reconstruction Era to prevent African American southerners from achieving equality in society, the organization had grown into a domineering force in Southern life. They publicly lynched African Americans attempting to vote as part of their effort to disenfranchise the Black population. Although they disappeared for a short while, they resurfaced in 1915 with the White-supremacist goal of attacking not

only Black people, but Jews, Catholics, and immigrants. Despite being a terrorist organization, White-supremacist members of HUAC decided against investigation, demonstrating the subjectivity of their investigations to align with the members' "idealized" version of America.

While Mississippi Representative John Rankin, a member of the previous Dies Committee, was the one who insisted that the committee continue upon Dies's retirement in 1945, the HUAC was chaired by Edward Hart, a New Jersey Democrat. Just two years later, John Parnell Thomas, a Republican, took over chairing the committee, and used his platform to oppose President Franklin D. Roosevelt's "New Deal" policies, which, again, emphasized welfare and contained socialist elements. Framing the policies as threatening to capitalism, he turned to Hollywood.

As the creative industry grew, so did loose interpretations about the purpose of their work – anything that remotely suggested criticism of the

United States government or engaged with foreign cultures was considered subversive communist propaganda. HUAC held a full nine days of trials against various 43 Hollywood figures to investigate communist motivations for their work. Upon 10 members refusing to answer certain questions by the committee and openly considering HUAC's investigations as violation of their First Amendment Rights, many of them were held in contempt of Congress and arrested. Known as the "Hollywood Ten", they and many more behind-the-scenes Hollywood minds, were blacklisted by the rest of the Hollywood community. Although there were only 10 directors, producers, and screenwriters convicted at the start, hundreds joined the "Hollywood Blacklist" as HUAC and other members of society grew more paranoid about communist infiltration. Religious, cultural, and political ambiguities that creatives (and many other prominent figures as well) set forth were interpreted by HUAC as threats. Again, blacklists were detrimental to people's livelihoods,

as only a tiny fraction of those investigated by HUAC and only convicted of perjury and contempt – not of any treasonous crime, though many were imprisoned for misdemeanors – were able to rebuild their careers or maintain respect in society. The “Hollywood Blacklist”, although technically an unofficial document, serves as one of the most, if not the most, prominent example of hysteria and derangement perpetrated by HUAC in the tense age of the Red Scare. In response, Hollywood turned to making explicitly anti-communist movies out of fear, demonstrating how HUAC’s paranoia took a grasp over society. However, investigations continued throughout the 1950s.

Following the “Hollywood Blacklist”, in 1948, Chair John Parnell was widely criticized for cruelty and corruption, for which he was indicted and incarcerated for 18 months. A Democratic Representative from Georgia, John Stephens Wood, took his place from 1949 until 1953. Once again demonstrating the true nature of this

committee, Wood was openly a member of the KKK. Rather than draw more attention to himself and the blatant racism that was widely criticized (once again, HUAC refused to investigate the KKK), he turned the committee’s attention back to Hollywood and the New Deal.

In the famous 1948 hearing, HUAC listened to former Soviet spy Whitaker Chambers, who now worked in the press as an open anti-communist. Chambers accused Alger Hiss and others of espionage. When many of them refused to testify, especially citing their Fifth Amendment Rights, and Hiss made many suspicious claims, HUAC’s suspicion resulted in his conviction of perjury, something that occurred often with the HUAC and succeeded in persuading people that the committee was necessary and important to the country’s safety. It remains a mystery whether Hiss was indeed a Soviet spy – various evidence suggests that he was, though most information remains classified.

Not only taking place in the House of Representatives, Joseph McCarthy was a Republican Senator from Wisconsin who stirred up anti-communist doctrine in the Senate. Elected in 1947, McCarthy is known for his actions in 1950, when he announced his knowledge of more than 200 Department of State (DoS) employees who were communists. He chaired the Senate Permanent Subcommittee on Investigations, in which he used his “list” to investigate communism within the federal government as well as the press. He was very persistent in his investigations, so much so that people and the press referred to his tactics against alleged communists as “McCarthyism”. His convictions and tactics greatly influenced members of HUAC and guided their actions.

In tandem with intense fear of the left and White-supremacy was a culture that feared anyone who differed from the “norm”, notably gay men. While the nation became increasingly aware of homosexuality, discomfort toward the topic heightened. This gave rise to what

is known as the Lavender Scare, in which hundreds of gay federal employees were hunted down and fired. Sparked by McCarthy’s rhetoric that proposed a connection between gay people and communists (namely, that they both had “peculiar mental twists”), the Lavender Scare put gay federal employees in an impossible position in which they either had to resign or be publicly outed by Congressional investigators. The media engaged with Congress to portray homosexuality as “sociopathic”, effectively making America hostile towards minorities and destroying the lives and futures of gay men.

In such a paranoid age, it took little proof to convince people that their fears were true and someone was, indeed, a communist. Even if people were not charged with any crime and found not to be communist, pure accusations tarnished their reputation, which remained with them. Others feared to be associated with them out of protection for their own livelihoods, which often alienated them from their

friends and family. In fact, roughly 80% of people mentioned by HUAC were fired and blacklisted, even if they were innocent. Should someone serve as a witness, the mere publicity was scrutinizing; every move was under a microscope, and should they not comply, they, too, would be targeted. Oftentimes, witnesses were pressured – even threatened – into naming other communists, even if these people did not exist. This put witnesses in an impossible position, as they either would be viewed as guilty to HUAC if they did not comply or a traitor to the people if they

did. To protect themselves, most people complied, which created a domino effect in which the newly named people were forced to do the same. Creating widespread panic, HUAC induced a culture where standing out in any way was dangerous and people desperately attempted to fit in. Frightened of the alternative, most people went along with HUAC's mission, perpetuating the hysteria.

Current Situation

In January of 1953, when this committee session begins, Republican President Dwight D. Eisenhower is inaugurated, marking the end of 20 years of Democratic occupation of the White House. Additionally, the 83rd Congress sees Republican majorities in both the House of Representatives and the Senate, again marking a turning point for the government. With this change, HUAC sees new

leadership, now chaired by Harold Velde, an Illinois Republican. Velde is an outspoken critic of the left-leaning economic and social policies (such as the previous decade's New Deal), going as far as to accuse former President Harry Truman of intentionally appointing a Soviet Spy to the federal government, although the President refuses to testify. In March of 1953, Velde stirs up criticism when he suggests that HUAC

should turn their attention to investigating churches for communist activity. Upon doing this, Representative FDR Jr. attempts to remove him from his role as Chairman, though his resolution does not pass. As a result of his radical agenda, Velde's leadership is fragile.

As a result of activity throughout the previous decade, the debates about violation of First and Fifth Amendment Rights continue to rage on. Particularly, witnesses that "plead the Fifth", or, in other words, refused to testify (the amendment removes the necessity to self-incriminate), are assumed to have admitted guilt. Legally, such interpretation of "pleading the Fifth" is not permissible, and it should not be considered evidence of guilt. Additionally, the debate of the extent to which government criticism and personal beliefs were protected by the First Amendment and not propaganda rages on.

Despite such open controversy, criticism of HUAC comes at a cost. Both Democratic Senator William Benton and Congresswoman Helen Gahagan Douglas publicly denounced McCarthy and HUAC for having tactics that resembled facism –

both then lost their next reelection bids. Thus, committee members must be cautious.

1953 is a year of major foreign adjustment that rattles the Northern Hemisphere. To be considered during the progress of this committee, the year sees the death of Joseph Stalin in March. Stalin was dictator of the Soviet Union for decades and led the nation to victory in World War II (on the side of the Allies). He is known for his brutality, totalitarianism, and the "Great Purge", in which he executed and imprisoned millions as part of his brutal (yet, successful) effort to transform the Soviet Union from an agrarian society to an industrial powerhouse.

Additionally, there is large unrest in the East, as the Viet Minh conflict enters its final years. In this communist independence movement, leader Ho Chi Minh led his followers to rebel against French rule and Japanese occupation in northern Vietnam in 1945. The conflict was successful in declaring Vietnam's independence, but an extremely violent eight years of guerilla warfare. It preceded the Vietnam War.

Furthermore, the Korean War enters the year at a height of violence and tension,

with the Soviet Union and China on North Korea's side, and the United States on South Korea's. In reality, the war serves as a proxy conflict between the United States and the rising Eastern alliance of China (with the major and rising communist influence of Mao Zedong) and the Soviets as a part of the

Cold War. The Cold War is at its height, and both the United States and The Soviet Union successfully test nuclear weapons, bringing intense fear throughout both populaces.

HUAC Objectives

Again, this committee commences in January of 1953. As tensions boil over in the Cold War, preventing the spread of communism not only abroad but also at home is an increasing priority. HUAC's obligation is to halt the spread of communism and identify any threats that it may pose to national security and the nation's future as a free, pluralistic democracy. Given that the committee holds no true judicial power or access to intelligence, military, or technology, HUAC must rely upon subpoenas, witness testimony, accusations of perjury, blacklist, and cooperation with executive-branch federal agencies, such as the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) or the Central Intelligence Agency (CIA).

The committee will begin by addressing the following issues: allegedly communist Hollywood propaganda, Soviet (and their allies') actions to perpetuate their communist influence, and Americans reacting to – and possibly supporting the wrong side of – the height of the Viet Minh and Korean War. Of course, the committee should address all of this through the lens of internal communist subversion and national security.

It is essential that committee members cooperate to achieve (or, at least, publicly seem to achieve) their goals, though trust no one. Every committee member holds their own motivations, and these tensions should become more apparent over the course of the committee.

Furthermore, as delegates work together to contain and suppress communism, they must also protect their own reputations from the public, other Congressmen, and even fellow committee members. A key topic of discussion should be how to handle McCarthy's increasingly controversial image in a way that would not tarnish the committee's image. In the

likelihood that the HUAC loses the confidence of the American populace, its members would certainly be defamed along with the committee. Additionally, their efforts would be squandered and their mission futile.

Delegate Positions

Please research as much as you can about your committee member, including but not limited to his personal political goals, public image, and who he is most likely to target. This should serve as a mere overview.

1. **Harold H. Velde (R)** Born in Illinois in 1910, Velde went to Northwestern University and coached sports for a few years before becoming a lawyer. Velde was a special counterespionage FBI agent during World War II and ran for the House of Representatives in 1949, where he chairs HUAC and becomes a very prominent member of Congress. He champions national security and hopes HUAC is the way he can accomplish this, recognizing the importance of the committee's public image.
2. **Francis E. Walter (D)** Born in Pennsylvania in 1894, Walter served in the military during World War I and was elected to Congress in 1933. He concerns himself with domestic security and immigration topics, and in 1952, he co-writes the McCarran-Walter Act, which lifts restrictions on Asian immigration while strengthening government ability to deport suspected communists. He chairs HUAC starting in 1955, openly criticizing communism. Walter's goals are both

national security and legacy as a successful legislator, explaining his patriotic and tactful approach.

3. **John E. Rankin (D)** Born in Mississippi in 1882, Rankin was elected to Congress in 1920 and reelected for decades. He is an open White-supremacist, anti-communist, and supports FDR's New Deal policies. Rankin was an early and prominent HUAC member, championing racism and populism at once. He has a prominent role on the House Veterans' Affairs Committee and carries himself with an aggressive, arrogant role as someone trying to protect "traditional" America and his own governmental power.
4. **Clyde Doyle (D)** Born in California, Doyle was elected to Congress in 1944 and again in 1948 after losing his 1946 election bid. Since his reelection, he became a member of HUAC, but, as a former member of the California Board of Education, he remains skeptical of HUAC's widely criticized tactics while acknowledging and supporting its mission. The committee's image is thus an important issue to him. Doyle also supports labor rights and progressive movements, making it difficult for him to cooperate in extreme scenarios. He voices concerns regarding the fairness of HUAC's targets, which may lead to conflict with other committee members.
5. **Charles J. Kersten (R)** Born in Illinois in 1902, Kersten was elected to Congress in 1946 following his prominent role in his law career in Wisconsin. During his time in the House, Kersten serves as chairman of the United States House Select Committee to Investigate Communist Aggression and the Forced Incorporation of the Baltic States into the U.S.S.R., highlighting his anti-communist beliefs. Kersten is a close friend of then-Representative Richard Nixon and later serves briefly in the Eisenhower administration before returning to law and anti-communist activism.
6. **Joseph McCarthy (R)** Born in Wisconsin in 1908, McCarthy is a Senator famous for his rampant anti-communist missions during the Cold War, contributing to

mass hysteria surrounding communist subversion. He is elected to the Senate in 1946 and serves for 10 years until his death. He gained national attention after claiming he possessed a list of State Department communists and chairs his own Senate committee. McCarthy is eventually censured in 1954 for publicly displaying his brutal tactics and abuse of power, but his influence does not fade for a long time. As of 1953, though, he still maintains his respected role in Congress and is adamant about his anti-communist convictions.

7. **Karl Mundt (R)** Born in South Dakota in 1900, Mundt was elected to Congress in 1938 following his career as a teacher and broadcaster. He worked with Richard Nixon to support the Mundt-Nixon Bill with the effort of controlling subversive organizations. Elected to the Senate in 1948, his efforts are directed at domestic security, foreign policy, and staunch anti-communism. He is well-spoken, passionate, and idealist, hoping for American success through combatting communism.
8. **Strom Thurmond (D)** Born in South Carolina in 1902, Thurmond was elected governor in 1946 following his career as a teacher, lawyer, and state legislator. He notably ran for president as the nominee for the States' Rights Democratic party and managed to win four Southern states. Thurmond was elected to the Senate as a write-in-candidate, carrying his racist ideals and segregationism with him. He is passionate, disciplined, and determined to achieve personal goals as well as ensure that Southern states maintain their rights of racial segregation.
9. **John F. Kennedy (D)** Born in Massachusetts in 1917, Kennedy was elected to Congress in 1946 following his success as a World War II Navy hero. He is elected to the Senate in 1952 as an incredibly likeable, charismatic, and intelligent person. Unlike many of his colleagues, he is young, charming, persuasive, and intellectual. Currently writing a book, Kennedy is using his time in the Senate to set himself up for a more important and prominent role in the federal government.

- 10. Sam Rayburn (D)** Born in Tennessee in 1882, Rayburn was elected to Congress from Texas in 1912, quickly rising to become a very influential and powerful member of the time. He held the important role of House Majority Leader in 1937 and even Speaker of the House several times. His input is crucial during New Deal and World War II legislation, and he always maintains dignity and decency in his work. He believes in following rules, being disciplined, and coming to a practical solution for the greater good of the nation and Congress's legacy. His integrity is refreshing at times, especially during an age characterized by fear and corruption.
- 11. Richard Nixon (R)** Born in California in 1913, Nixon was elected to Congress in 1946 after rising up as a Navy soldier during World War II. He serves on HUAC and was notable for his role in the Chambers-Hiss trial. He is a Senator in 1950 and, at Eisenhower's inauguration in 1953, he becomes Vice President. Nixon is very strategic, from a place of wanting to prove himself suitable for a more important national role. He is very anti-communist, though more motivated by his own ambition.
- 12. Barry Goldwater (R)** Born in Arizona in 1909, Goldwater started in local politics after running his family business in a department store. He is elected to the United States Senate in 1952 and strongly opposed New Deal policies, championing conservatism. His influence grows as he speaks more for the Republicans in a straightforward and passionate way. He hopes to influence, mold, and restore American conservatism, which entails securing the ideals of capitalism and American principles over communist influences in the nation.
- 13. J. Edgar Hoover (FBI)** Born in Washington D.C. in 1895, Hoover is an important law enforcement administrator. President Calvin Coolidge appointed him as the last director of the Bureau of Investigation (BOI, precursor to the FBI) and the first director of the FBI. Hoover remains in his position for decades, contributing to many new policing technologies, such as forensics. Hoover starts the national blacklist, known as the FBI Index. Despite his contributions, Hoover

is discovered to have abused his power and access to intelligence to pursue political opponents. Having an intelligence and law-enforcement perspective could be very useful to HUAC, especially someone willing to use intelligence in any way necessary.

14. Allen Dulles (CIA) Born in 1893, Dulles serves as head of the Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) following his career as a lawyer. During the Cold War, he was responsible for overseeing important events such as the 1953 Iranian Coup D'état and the 1961 Bay of Pigs Invasion, a failure for which President Kennedy forces him to resign. He had an early career in Europe with notable concerns about how the Germans treated Jewish Europeans, ensuring that he was anti-facist and anti-communist. He supports government transparency during the Cold War, although he is at odds with McCarthy, demanding that McCarthy stop subpoenaing him. Dulles fears that congressional probing for information would damage the CIA's security and reputation, going as far as to direct agents to break into his office and feed him false information. Dulles provides the perspective that national security is actually threatened by the committee's actions, not helped.

15. Elia Kazan (Entertainment) Born in Turkey in 1909, Kazan is a Greek-American immigrant and filmmaker who attended the Yale School of Drama. He has a successful acting and theater career before going on to directing extremely successful films that address social problems in the United States, most notably antisemitism and racism. One of his films receives eight Oscar nominations and three awards. Kazan served as a "friendly witness" to HUAC during the height of the "Hollywood Blacklist", cooperating and providing names – even those of friends he promised not to name. His cooperation with the committee stirs up a lot of criticism, and his career declines as he became a more controversial figure.

16. Dalton Trumbo (Entertainment) Born in Colorado in 1905, Trumbo is a world famous screenwriter whose work included *Spartacus*, and *Johnny Got His Gun*.

However, his career takes a sharp turn when he refuses to testify to HUAC and becomes one of the “Hollywood Ten”, effectively blacklisting him among his colleagues. He uses pseudonyms to continue writing, even winning Oscars under other names. It is not until 2011 that he is retroactively given credit for his widely praised films, but his struggles force him into silence very early on. In 1953, he is preparing to release a very successful hit, *Roman Holiday*, under a pseudonym, for which he wins an Academy Award for Best Story.

- 17. Walt Disney (Entertainment)** Born in Illinois in 1901, Disney is perhaps one of the most famous, successful, and remembered people in the history of entertainment. He is an animator, producer, actor, and businessman, who pioneers the way for cartoonists and holds the record for Academy Award nominations and wins. During the Great Depression, when people often attended movie theaters for cheap entertainment, and into the 1940s, Disney crafted his content to be patriotic during times of global unrest and war, carrying himself as an American “cultural-imperialist”. He, too, allegedly holds antisemitic and racist doctrines, but overall is aware of his influence and commits himself to producing anti-communist content.

Questions to Consider

Here are some questions to help guide you in conference speeches and our collaborative investigation together.

1. What personal stake does your role have in the success of this committee?
2. What is your role’s motivation for thwarting the threat of communism, if any?
3. Does your role’s personal interests at all conflict with the committee’s?
4. What is the best possible outcome – ideal situation – for your role in this committee? Consider both realistic and unrealistic objectives.

5. In what ways might the committee's effort to achieve its goals conflict with its effort to maintain a positive public image?
6. How might you go about handling other delegates with different objectives than yours?
7. Is there any information that your colleagues must not find out?
8. What outside agencies, if any, could help you achieve your goals?
9. How might you convince the committee to listen to and act on your ideas, especially if you have ulterior motives?
10. How might you handle a situation in which the committee decides not to follow your delegate's lead, possibly going as far to suspect or accuse you of something?
11. What are 5 adjectives you might use to describe your role, and how might this look in your interactions with other delegates? Is your role the assertive type? Quiet type?
12. What perspective might your role bring to the committee that no one else would? In what way is your role indispensable?

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